

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 894

By Massey

A RESOLUTION to honor and recognize Knoxville Community Media on the occasion of its fiftieth anniversary.

WHEREAS, this General Assembly takes great pleasure in recognizing a nonprofit organization that has helped promote and preserve free speech in its community for the past fifty years; and

WHEREAS, Knoxville Community Media (KCM) is an independently chartered 501(c)(3) organization created in 1975 to serve the community of Knoxville and Knox County by providing public, educational, and government access through television and other media outlets; and

WHEREAS, the existence of KCM encourages civic engagement and participation through its coverage and archiving of gavel-to-gavel government meetings; and

WHEREAS, KCM assists educational entities, organizations, community groups, and nonprofit organizations in sharing their mission with the community; and

WHEREAS, KCM offers life-skills training and equipment that enable the citizens of Knoxville and Knox County to share their beliefs, dreams, and values through a media platform for free speech; and

WHEREAS, KCM was a vital resource during the COVID-19 pandemic and has continued to offer all of the aforementioned services at little or no cost to the community, even in the face of revenue loss; and

WHEREAS, KCM remains a true beacon of unfiltered free thought, free expression, and free speech, providing a modern form of the public town square in a media age in which many media outlets do not allow unfiltered free thought, free expression, or free speech; and

WHEREAS, KCM and its staff are richly deserving of our approbation on this special occasion; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor and recognize Knoxville Community Media upon fifty years of service to the community as a champion of free speech, as KCM looks forward to fifty more years of responsible, thoughtful, and important media-making and the preservation of localism in media.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.